

TIMELINE

January 9, 1913 Born the second of five children to Frank Nixon, the owner of a service station, and Hannah Milhous Nixon, a committed Quaker, in Yorba Linda, California.

1922 The Nixon family moves to Whittier; Richard excels in high school and becomes a skilled debater.

1929 Enrolls at Whittier College rather than accept a scholarship to Harvard, in order to care for his ailing father.

1934 Receives a full scholarship to Duke University School of Law.

1938 Returns to Whittier and joins a local law firm.

1940 Marries Thelma "Pat" Ryan after meeting her through a theater group.

1942 Rejects conscientious objector status as a pacifist Quaker and enlists in the US Navy. Serves as a junior officer in the Pacific.

1946 Whittier Republicans draft him to run for California's 12th Congressional District; victory in November sends him to Washington, D.C.

1950–53 Elected to the Senate, where he is known as an avid anticommunist.

1953–61 Serves as Dwight Eisenhower's vice president.

1960 Looks tired and sickly in the televised presidential debate with John F. Kennedy and later loses the election.



TELEVISED PRESIDENTIAL DEBATE, 1960

1962 Defeated by Pat Brown in the California gubernatorial election.

1968 Finally achieves his long-term goal of becoming the president, running on a "bring home the troops" platform, with Spiro Agnew as running mate.

January 27, 1973 Approves the Paris Peace Accords.

August 8, 1974 Forced to resign in the wake of the Watergate scandal.

April 22, 1994 Dies after a massive stroke. He is buried in Yorba Linda.